



SHIPPING WATCH

POLESTAR INSIGHTS

REPORTING PERIOD: 18 MAY 2026 - 24 MAY 2026

POLESTAR-ADVISORY.COM

DATA STATUS: STATIC / IMPORT ONLY

LATEST RECORD: 22 MAY 2026

LAST UPDATED: 23 MAY 2026

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Maritime reporting was centred on chokepoint risk, commercial disruption and insurance and freight pressure. Iran produced the strongest identifiable signal, with lower volumes from China and South Korea. Severity peaked at moderate.

FAST FACTS

REPORTING PERIOD 18 May - 24 May 2026	RECORDS IN WINDOW 14	HIGHEST SEVERITY Moderate
MAIN AFFECTED CHOKEPOINT (30D) Strait of Hormuz 194 records	VESSEL ATTACKS / SEIZURES (30D) 9	PIRACY / ARMED ROBBERY (30D) 2 Latest record in window: 22 May 2026
LATEST SIGNIFICANT INCIDENT 22 May 2026 Iran proposes permanent toll for Strait of Hormuz shipping		

CHOKEPOINT / ROUTE READ

The 30-day picture is led by Strait of Hormuz, which carries 87 qualifying records and a highest severity of extreme. Gulf of Oman follows with 1 record.

Inside the weekly briefing window, 6 records pointed at transit, diversion or advisory pressure — a tighter view of what shippers actually felt across the cycle.

Watch for new naval advisories on Strait of Hormuz, any war-risk premium adjustments and operator commentary on rerouting. Those are the early indicators of escalation; commercial freight rates lag them by days.

CHOKEPOINT	RECORDS	HIGHEST SEV	LATEST	OPERATIONAL READ
Strait of Hormuz	87	EXTREME	22 May 2026	Reporting was led by "Iran proposes permanent toll for Strait of Hormuz shipping", with 87 qualifying records over the last 30 days.
Gulf of Oman	1	MODERATE	14 May 2026	Activity here was anchored by a single entry, "Two India-Bound LPG Tankers Clear Hormuz in Dark Mode", over the last 30 days.
Arabian / Persian Gulf	1	LOW	04 May 2026	Activity here was anchored by a single entry, "Strait of Hormuz traffic drops to 14 ships, with most leaving Persian Gulf: CAS", over the last 30 days.
Red Sea	1	LOW	07 May 2026	Activity here was anchored by a single entry, "Drewry: Suez Canal Containership Crossings Recover", over the last 30 days.
Bab el-Mandeb	0	—	—	Quiet over the last 30 days; no qualifying activity on file.
Malacca Strait	0	—	—	Quiet over the last 30 days; no qualifying activity on file.

VESSEL THREAT AND PIRACY READ

Vessel-threat reporting over the last 30 days carries 9 qualifying events after dedupe, of which 9 are an attack or seizure rather than a softer boarding or approach. The lead entry is "UKMTO Reports Vessel Seized by Unauthorized Personnel Near Strait of Hormuz - News and Statistics - IndexBox". Piracy and armed-robbery reporting carries 2 records across the same window, with "Armed robbers board bulk carrier in Singapore Strait" as the lead entry.

Inside the weekly briefing cycle itself, no fresh vessel-side or piracy records were filed; the read leans on the trailing 30-day picture.

Track maritime advisories, naval-force statements and any movement in war-risk or P&I premiums on affected routes. Those are the cleanest early indicators that hostile activity is firming or easing.

VESSEL ATTACKS, LAST 30 DAYS (25 APR - 24 MAY 2026)

DATE	ACT	TITLE	SEVERITY
15 May 2026	Seized	UKMTO Reports Vessel Seized by Unauthorized Personnel Near Strait of Hormuz - News and Statistics - IndexBox	EXTREME
14 May 2026	Seized	Vessel seized off UAE coast by unauthorized individuals now heading toward Iranian waters - The New Voice of Ukraine	LOW
14 May 2026	Seized	Hormuz Crisis: Vessel Seized Off UAE Heading to Iran - Deccan Herald	EXTREME
11 May 2026	Attack	UKMTO reports vessel attack on bulk carrier off Doha - Safety4Sea	LOW
06 May 2026	Attack	Cargo vessel hit by projectile in Strait of Hormuz: UKMTO - MSN	LOW
05 May 2026	Attack	Cargo Vessel Struck by Unknown Projectile in Strait of Hormuz: UKMTO - Caspian Post	LOW
04 May 2026	Attack	US launches naval escort plan as tanker hit in Strait of Hormuz - Aaj English TV	EXTREME
04 May 2026	Attack	Tanker hit by unknown projectiles off UAE coast near Strait of Hormuz - Global Times	LOW
27 Apr 2026	Seized	Somalia piracy: Another vessel seized as threat level increased - BBC	MODERATE

PIRACY AND ARMED ROBBERY, LAST 30 DAYS (25 APR - 24 MAY 2026)

DATE	ACT	TITLE	SEVERITY
05 May 2026	Boarding	Armed robbers board bulk carrier in Singapore Strait	MODERATE
27 Apr 2026	Piracy	Somalia piracy: Another vessel seized as threat level increased - BBC	MODERATE

COMMERCIAL IMPACT ON SHIPPING

No port, freight, insurance or commercial-shipping disruption records reached the file in the weekly window. Pure market commentary — newbuild orders, vessel S&P, fleet finance, earnings, share-price moves — is intentionally excluded from this section, so a blank cycle here means the operational disruption signal was genuinely quiet rather than under-reported.

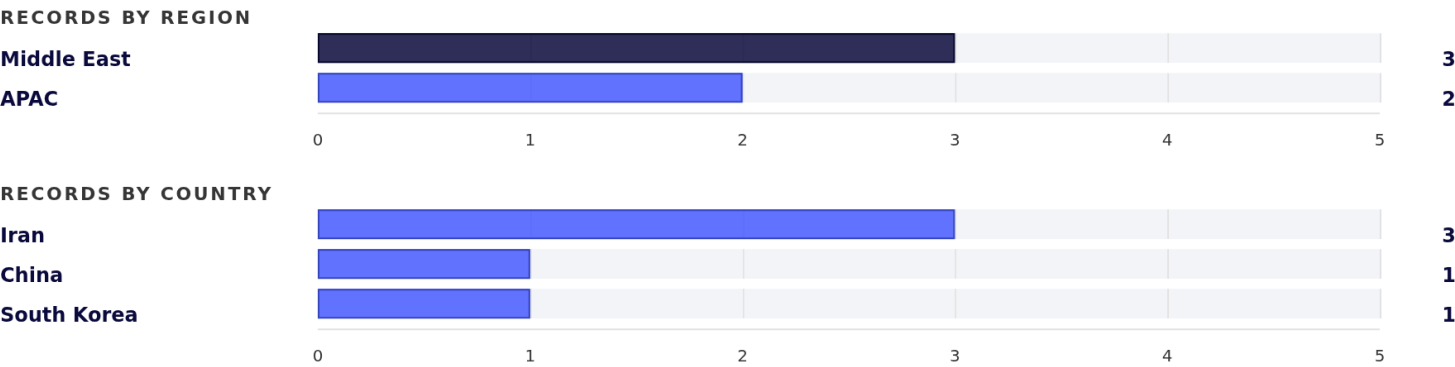
Watch for fresh port advisories, schedule slippage out of the major box and tanker hubs, and any insurance-premium adjustments tied to specific routes. Those are the next signals that operational commercial pressure is firming.

No port, freight, insurance or commercial-shipping disruption records in the weekly window.

REGIONAL AND COUNTRY VIEW

Across the weekly briefing window, Middle East carries the heavier share with 3 records against 2 for APAC. At country level the cycle is led by Iran (3), China (1) and South Korea (1).

A further 9 records could not be tied to a confirmed incident country and are excluded from the country chart to avoid distortion.



WHAT MATTERS

Pressure here feeds straight into transit time, freight cost and war-risk premium exposure across the wider region. A small shift on any one chokepoint usually shows up in the freight and insurance read soon after.

IMPLICATIONS FOR BUSINESS

- Re-walk routing options around affected chokepoints, port-call sequencing, bunker planning and war-risk premium exposure. Confirm crew-change and advisory triggers with operators.

WATCH NEXT

- Next cycle hinges on a handful of triggers: fresh port closures or strikes, naval movement near Hormuz, Bab-el-Mandeb or the Malacca approaches, new maritime advisories, and visible moves in war-risk premiums or freight indices.

POLESTAR VIEW

Chokepoint exposure remains the dominant operational concern, supported by freight and insurance pressure and a thinner layer of commercial disruption. Iran carries the strongest identifiable signal, with lower volumes linked to China and South Korea.

RELATED INCIDENTS

DATE	ISSUE	TITLE	SEVERITY
15 May 2026	Vessel seizure	UKMTO Reports Vessel Seized by Unauthorized Personnel Near Strait of Hormuz - News and Statistics - IndexBox	EXTREME
22 May 2026	Chokepoint risk	Iran proposes permanent toll for Strait of Hormuz shipping	LOW
22 May 2026	Chokepoint risk	Strait of Hormuz closure risks greatest global energy supply shock in decades, Wood Mackenzie warns	MODERATE
21 May 2026	Chokepoint risk	First coordinated VLCC transits through Hormuz raise cautious hopes of a thaw	LOW
21 May 2026	Chokepoint risk	Strait of Hormuz disruption helps drive 8% rise in Panama Canal transits	LOW
20 May 2026	Chokepoint risk	FM Cho says probe into Hormuz Strait vessel attack in final stage	LOW

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